

4.3 Assessment information

1 Assessment overview

The music to be performed for this unit is internally set and assessed by the centre, recorded by the centre and externally moderated by Edexcel.

Students can perform as a soloist and/or as part of an ensemble. Teachers and students can choose music in any style. Any instrument(s) and/or voice(s) are acceptable as part of a 12-15 minute performance of a balanced programme of music. Notated and/or improvised performances may be submitted.

The 12-15 minute performance will be assessed by the teacher and may be recorded and rerecorded at any time during the course. The music must be performed to the teacher and at least one other person. A larger audience may be present at the student's discretion.

2 Items for submission

1) A recording of the piece(s) on audio CD (finalised and playable on standard domestic equipment or MiniDisc™ (long-play MiniDisc™ recordings are not acceptable). Recordings on cassette tape will not be accepted.

Recordings must be made in one take, not piece by piece on separate occasions.

Each student's work should be on a separate audio CD or MiniDisc™, clearly labelled with their details. Centres are requested to use one recording format for all their students' submissions — audio CD or MiniDisc™. Recordings must be made in one take, not piece by piece on separate occasions.

2) Photocopies of the music (only the part performed needs to be submitted eg just the clarinet part in a piece for clarinet with piano accompaniment) must be submitted with the recording for moderation. Original copies should not be supplied. Photocopies will be destroyed by Edexcel at the end of the examination series.

Where no printed staff notation exists (for example, where students offer their own compositions) centres must still supply a score* in a format appropriate to the style of the music. Whatever format is chosen, the presentation must be sufficiently clear for the moderator to be able to make an assessment of the performance.

*The word score refers to any of the following: a full score in conventional staff notation; a lead sheet or chord chart; track sheets; tables or diagrams.

3) Both the teacher and the student must sign an authentication form to verify that the submission is the student's own unaided work.

3 Ensemble performing	Ensembles performances must have a maximum of five performers including the student. Student must have a clearly defined role and play a part that is not duplicated by any other member of the ensemble. More than one student may be assessed in the course of a single ensemble performance.
4 Improvisation	Improvised solo or ensemble performances will only be accepted if a chord scheme or other stimulus is supplied, together with as much information as possible about the student's working methods.
5 Sequenced performances	Sequenced performances will be accepted provided that the final track is performed live, at the correct speed and without further editing.
6 Use of accompaniment	Music that was written with an accompaniment must be performed with that accompaniment. Students offering solo performances with accompaniment will generally only be accompanied by one other performer playing a contrasting instrument. For instance, a singer, flautist or trombonist may be accompanied by a pianist, or a jazz saxophonist may be accompanied by a double bass player. However, students can perform with a larger ensemble where there is a clear solo part throughout and the music was originally written for these forces. Students may perform with a backing track if they wish.
7 Difficulty of pieces	The expected difficulty of pieces offered is taken to correspond to Grade 6 of the graded examinations of such bodies as the Associated Board of the Royal Schools of Music, Trinity Guildhall, Rockschoo and the London College of Music. When students perform a piece at a level that exceeds Grade 6, additional credit will be awarded. See the Difficulty Level grid on page 82.

When students perform a piece at a level below Grade 6, the demand is not such that full credit under any of the assessment criteria can be justified. For a piece classified as Grade 5, the top band of mark(s) under each criterion is therefore not available (for example, Quality of Outcome can receive only 7/8 marks however outstanding the performance). For a piece that is easier still, the top two mark bands are unavailable.

Care should be taken in determining the difficulty of an individual part within an ensemble piece. Individual parts must be compared to solo graded pieces to determine the level of difficulty, while taking account of the added difficulty of the ensemble playing of a particular piece.

8 Short submissions

The minimum requirement in terms of length is 12 minutes' performance time. For each half minute that a student falls short of this requirement, a reduction of 2 marks is made. For example, a student who performs for 10 minutes 20 seconds has fallen short by three half minutes. A final mark of 28/50 will be reduced by 6 (3×2) to 22/50. A performance lasting 9 minutes 40 seconds will be reduced by 8 (4×2).

Note: If a reduction for a short submission has to be made, this is done at the *very end* of the marking process after the averaging of marks for the various pieces and the addition of the 10 marks in Criterion 6.